

Best Practices for Writing Good Prompts



Be clear and specific

Always tell the AI exactly what you need. Give enough detail so it understands the task. Clear and detailed prompts make the AI give faster, more accurate, and more useful answers.

✗ Before:

"Help me with JavaScript."

✓ After:

"Show me how to add two numbers in JavaScript and print the result."

✗ Before:

"Explain arrays."

✓ After:

"Explain how to get the first item from an array in JavaScript. Use a simple example with fruits."



Garbage in, garbage out

The quality of the answer depends on the quality of your prompt. If your request is vague or missing details, the result will not be useful. But if you write with clear words, correct details, and enough context, code sources, technical stack, library names and sometimes versions the AI will give you much better results

✗ Before:

"Fix my code."

✓ After:

"Fix this JavaScript code: [paste code]. It should return the right sum, but it gives the wrong result."

✗ Before:

"Write unit tests."

✓ After:

"Write unit tests for the calculateDiscount function [paste code]. The project uses TypeScript and Vitest. Cover cases for 0%, 10%, and 50% discounts."



Use good grammar and spelling

The AI looks at grammar and spelling to understand your request. If the prompt has many mistakes, the result may be wrong. Writing correctly makes the answer more accurate.

✗ Before:

"mak js fuction add num plz fast"

✓ After:

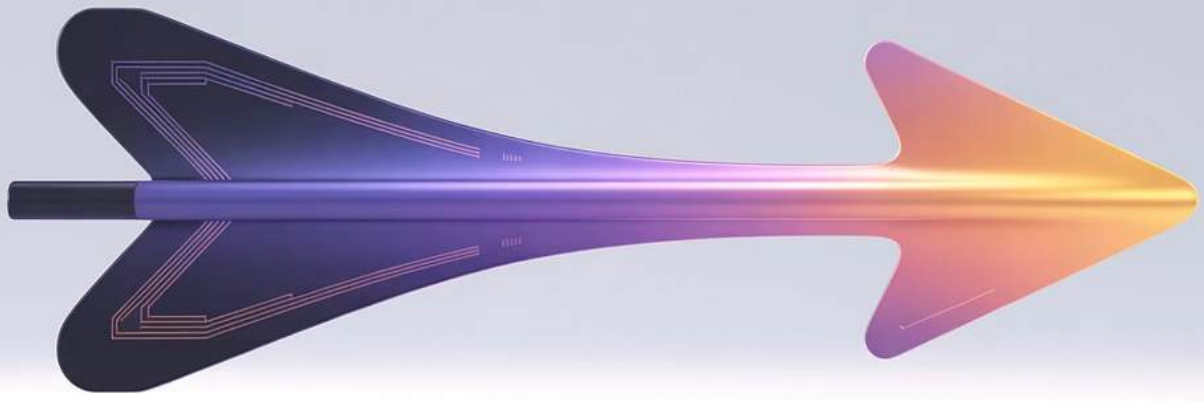
"Make a JavaScript function that adds two numbers."

✗ Before:

"how js arry work expl"

✓ After:

"Explain how arrays work in JS with a simple example."



Keep it short and simple

Don't add extra words that don't help. A short and clear prompt is often better than a long one full of fluff. Too much text can confuse the AI.

✗ Before:

"Hi ChatGPT, I am currently learning JavaScript and I was working on some exercises, but I feel very stuck and don't know how to move forward, so could you maybe show me, if it's not too hard, how to go through items in a list step by step because I don't know if I should use a loop or another way and I want to learn the easiest way that works for beginners."

✓ After:

"Show me how to loop through an array in JavaScript."



Give examples

If you want a specific style or format, show an example in your prompt. For instance, if you want names and ages in a list, write one example line. The AI will follow the pattern. Examples make your instructions clearer than long explanations.

✗ Before:

"Make a list of users."

✓ After:

"Make a list of 3 users in this format: Name – Age. Example: Anna – 25."

✗ Before:

"Write JavaScript objects for products."

✓ After:

"Write 2 product objects in JavaScript. Example format: { name: 'Phone', price: 500 }."



Split big tasks

When your task is big or complex, break it into smaller steps. Ask one clear question at a time instead of everything at once. You can also tell the AI what is most important to focus on, or ask it to give you a few options to choose from. This helps you get better and more organised results.

✗ Before:

"Teach me everything about JavaScript in one answer, including arrays, functions, loops, objects, async code, and also explain advanced stuff like promises and classes, and make sure you give me lots of examples for each so I understand all of it."

✓ After:

1. "Explain what a JavaScript function is with one simple example."
2. "Explain what is arrays and why they needed with simple example."



Work step by step

Think of prompting as a back-and-forth chat. Start with a simple request, read the answer, and then adjust your next prompt. If you don't like the result, change your wording, add more details, or try another angle. You don't have to write perfect prompts — just share your goal and let the AI guide you closer.

✗ Before:

"Build me an online shop website with login, database, shopping cart, payments, and also make it look nice with CSS, all in one go."

✓ After:

1. "Create a React project using [provide tech stack]."
2. "Create a login page with email and password fields, and make it look nice with simple styling."
3. ...



Make a plan

When you don't know where to start, ask the AI to make a roadmap. This could be a study plan, a project plan, or even a checklist of steps. Once you have the plan, you can go through each item one by one.

✗ Before:

"Teach me JavaScript."

✓ After:

"Make a **4-week study plan** for learning JavaScript. Include weekly goals, topics, and simple practice tasks."

✗ Before:

"Build me a React app."

✓ After:

"Make a **step-by-step plan** for building a React app with login, database, and a dashboard. Then we'll go through each step in order."



Set the tone

You can also tell the AI how you want the answer to "sound." Use words like *friendly*, *formal*, *casual*, *professional*, *funny*, or *serious*. For example: "Explain this in a friendly and easy way." Setting the tone helps the AI match your style better.

✗ Before:

"Explain the difference between const and let JavaScript variables."

✓ After:

"Explain the difference between const and let JavaScript variables in a **friendly and simple way**, like you're teaching a beginner."

✗ Before:

"Write project documentation for login feature."

✓ After:

"Write **professional documentation** for my project's login feature. Use clear sections and bullet points."